

Airliners Win Through

By the 1930s aviation had become part of many industrialized countries' transportation systems. Having demonstrated that air travel was viable, the aircraft manufacturers had to demonstrate that it was also safe and comfortable. Fully enclosed, insulated, and heated cabins became the norm, and twin-engine aircraft that could safely fly on one motor began to enter service.



△ Handley Page HP42 1931

Origin UK

Engine 4 x 500 hp Bristol Jupiter XII air-cooled 9-cylinder radial

Top speed 120 mph (193 km/h)

Designed to an Imperial Airways specification, eight were built (four long-range HP-42s, four HP-45s) and all had names beginning with the letter "H." Although slow, none of them was ever involved in a fatal accident while in civilian service, making the type unique among its peers.



△ Armstrong Whitworth AW15 Atalanta 1931

Origin UK

Engine 4 x 340 hp Armstrong Whitworth Serval III air-cooled 10-cylinder 2-row radial

Top speed 174 mph (280 km/h)

In 1930 Armstrong Whitworth designed an aircraft to service Imperial Airways' African routes. Because the engines of the time were notoriously unreliable, Imperial Airways specified that four engines would be required.



△ Fokker FXVIII 1932

Origin Netherlands

Engine 3 x 420 hp Pratt & Whitney Wasp C air-cooled 9-cylinder radial

Top speed 150 mph (241 km/h)

The FXVIII was essentially an enlarged and improved variant of the Fokker Trimotor. However, questions over structural integrity and the drag penalty of the fixed undercarriage ensured it could not compete with more modern designs such as the DC-2.



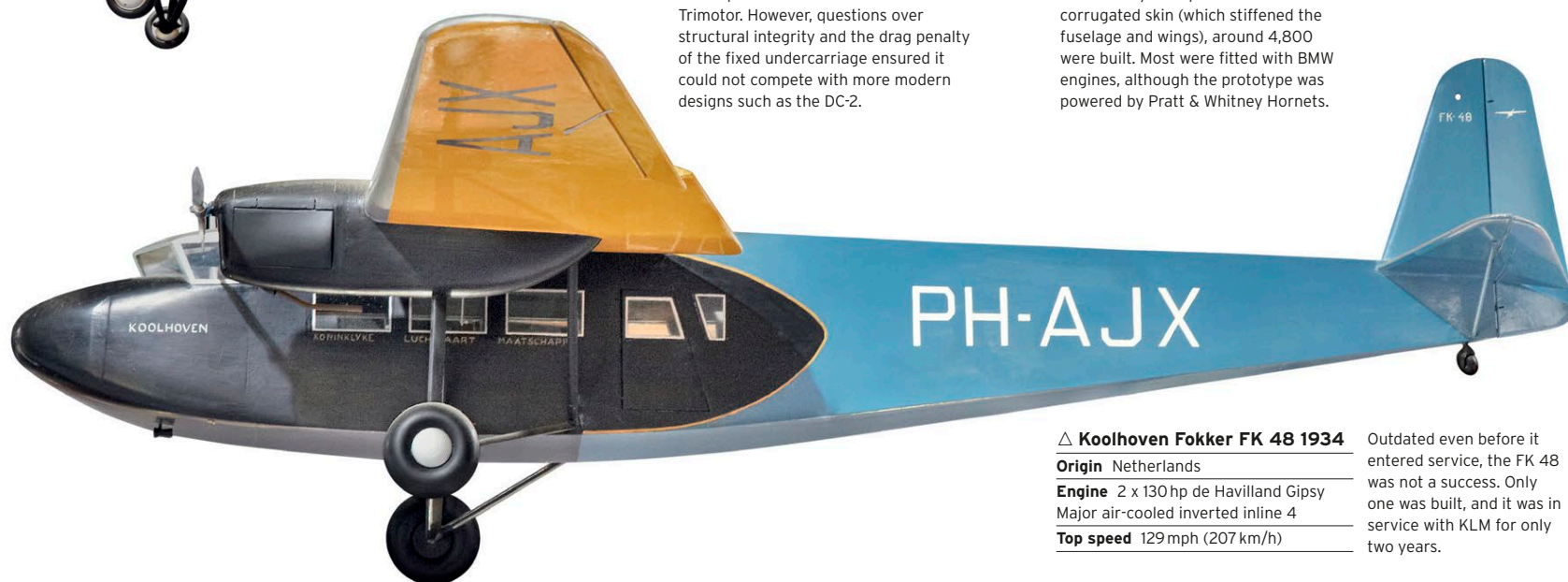
△ Junkers Ju 52/3m 1932

Origin Germany

Engine 3 x 715 hp BMW 132 air-cooled 9-cylinder radial

Top speed 168 mph (270 km/h)

Known as "Tante Ju" and "Iron Annie," the Ju 52 had a long and illustrious career as both a commercial airliner and military transport. Notable for its corrugated skin (which stiffened the fuselage and wings), around 4,800 were built. Most were fitted with BMW engines, although the prototype was powered by Pratt & Whitney Hornets.



△ Koolhoven Fokker FK 48 1934

Origin Netherlands

Engine 2 x 130 hp de Havilland Gipsy Major air-cooled inverted inline 4

Top speed 129 mph (207 km/h)

Outdated even before it entered service, the FK 48 was not a success. Only one was built, and it was in service with KLM for only two years.